

HARIS FARUQI

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EDUCATION

University of California, Merced

Merced, CA

B.S. Computer Science & Engineering

Expected Spring 2027

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Discrete Mathematics, Computer Organization, Neural Networks, Probability & Statistics, Linear Algebra & Differential Equations, Circuit Theory, Full Stack Web Development

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C++, C, HTML, MIPS Assembly

Tools: Git/GitHub, Excel, Google Workspace

Concepts: Data Structures, Algorithm Design, OOP, Debugging, Computer Organization

Soft Skills: Leadership, Event Coordination, Written & Verbal Communication, Time Management

PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

Hackathon Organizer — AstroHacks, Irvine

Dec 2023 – April 2024

- Organized and ran a 65+ participant hackathon focused on technology and space exploration
- Managed all event logistics over a 12-hour event including sponsorships, registration, and scheduling
- Raised \$5,000+ in funding through outreach to local organizations and sponsors
- Led a team addressing real-time technical and operational issues under pressure

Game Master — Red Door Escape Room

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Managed 100+ guest experiences per week, maintaining high accuracy and quality under volume
- Troubleshooted technical and logistical issues in real time, demonstrating systematic problem-solving
- Consistently earned high guest satisfaction scores and performance-based recognition (LDOs)

PROJECTS

ML Classifier with Noise Robustness Testing

Python / scikit-learn

- Generated 4D synthetic cluster data, applied PCA for dimensionality reduction to 2D, and one-hot encoded labels for classification
- Built a scikit-learn pipeline with a standard scaler and logistic regression model; evaluated accuracy across Gaussian noise levels on the test set
- Visualized results and analyzed model degradation under noisy conditions, demonstrating understanding of ML pipelines and data preprocessing

CNN Filter Study

Python / Deep Learning

- Explored how convolutional filters extract features from images in a CNN, experimenting with different filter configurations and input images
- Gained hands-on understanding of convolution operations, feature maps, and how filter design impacts model perception

Word Frequency Algorithm

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- Built a program to parse input text and compute word frequencies, implementing efficient string manipulation and custom data structures

Recursive Calculator

MIPS Assembly

- Implemented a recursive calculator in MIPS assembly, managing stack frames, register allocation, and low-level control flow

2D Game Design

Godot Engine

- Designed and developed a 2D game including game logic, scene structure, and player mechanics using the Godot game engine

Flight Plan Calculator

C++ / GUI

- Developed a flight plan calculator with a custom user interface in C++, handling user input, route calculations, and real-time output display

Wordle Recreation

C++

- Recreated the Wordle word game with full game logic, win/loss tracking, and letter-matching feedback mechanics

Personal Website

HTML / CSS

- Designed and built a personal website from scratch, implementing responsive layout and clean UI design

CLUBS & ACTIVITIES

UC Merced Cybersecurity Club

UC Merced

- Participated in the Cybermonth CTF (Capture the Flag) competition, working through real-world attack and defense challenges
- Attended seminars and hands-on workshops covering network security, ethical hacking, and cybersecurity fundamentals

VOLUNTEER & LEADERSHIP

Leadership LLC — UC Merced

UC Merced

- Organized and supported charity events benefiting the local community as part of a residential leadership program
- Volunteered at a wildlife nature reserve during Elk Day, assisting with conservation and public education efforts
- Helped restore hiking trails and maintain paths for public use, contributing to local environmental stewardship

Link Crew Captain/President — High School Leadership Initiative

May 2022 – June 2024

- Trained ~100 student leaders and oversaw freshman orientation programming for 200+ students
- Coordinated events and communication between staff, students, and parents

REFERENCES

Available upon request.